Same Recipe, Different Fate: Safety Erosion from Benign Fine-Tuning Depends on Model Family and Training Recipe at 1B

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Abstract

Fine-tuning an aligned model on benign data can erode its safety, and published sizes of this erosion differ widely. We show that the effect of a training recipe on this erosion depends on the model family. We fine-tune instruct models from three families with LoRA on 4,800 Dolly rows. We measure the erosion E as the rise in the Unsafe share of 600 sampled answers to 200 harm prompts (Qwen3Guard). A standard Scheduled recipe (warmup, cosine decay and a token-mean loss) cuts OLMo-2-1B's erosion from $+45.1$ to $+28.8$ pp, but barely moves Llama-3.2-1B's ($+59.3$ to $+57.1$ pp; three seeds each). This family-by-recipe interaction excludes zero on two judges, Qwen3Guard and HarmBench, although we wrote the exact test late and it rests on about 5 degrees of freedom. A recipe that changes only the loss weighting shows that the schedule causes most of OLMo's cut. Under the constant-rate recipe, OLMo's erosion is partial, while Qwen2.5's and Llama's are near saturation; first seeds at 7–8B keep this order. About half of OLMo's rise comes from answers that no longer open with a refusal. A blind human read found that only about a third of Unsafe-labelled answers gave usable help, so we report lost refusal. In a pre-registered test, dark fiction eroded no more than light fiction; both eroded less than Dolly but refused more benign prompts. We report every setting we screened and the judges' limits.

1 Introduction

Fine-tuning an aligned language model on benign data can erode its safety (Qi et al., 2024; He et al., 2024). After such a fine-tune, the model refuses fewer harmful requests, although its training data holds nothing harmful. Small open models are often fine-tuned on their users' own data. So it matters how large this erosion is, and what sets its size.

Published numbers differ widely. Each study uses its own model family, training recipe, data and judge. Family contrasts exist (Hawkins et al., 2026; Khan et al., 2026; Guo et al., 2026), and optimisation choices drive much of the safety loss (Kim et al., 2025). Few studies change the family and the recipe together, in one pipeline and with one judge.

This note is the measurement stage of a larger study on repairing a model's safety after benign fine-tuning. A repair, or any change to the training data, can only show its effect where the erosion is partial: near zero there is little to repair, and near saturation the Unsafe share has little room to move. So we first needed to know which families and recipes give partial erosion, and how stable it is across seeds. This note reports what we found. The repair study will appear separately, and nothing here depends on it.

We ask what sets the size of the erosion at about 1B parameters. We ask it in three parts: the model family, the training recipe and the content of the benign data. We fine-tune OLMo-2-1B, Qwen2.5-1.5B, Qwen2.5-7B and Llama-3.2-1B on the same 4,800 Dolly rows with one LoRA recipe. Then we change only the loss weighting and the learning-rate schedule. Last, in a pre-registered test, we replace Dolly with dark or light fiction of the same format and length. The erosion E is the rise in the share of sampled answers to harm prompts that a safety judge labels Unsafe.[1]

We make three contributions:

- **The recipe's effect depends on the family.** A standard learning-rate schedule and loss cut OLMo's erosion by about a third, with over-refusal near the untuned level, but barely move Llama's. The interaction excludes zero on two judges (§4). On the main measure, the loss weighting accounts for about a fifth of OLMo's cut and the schedule for the rest

[1] All numbers come from development prompt sets; a held-out set is kept for the larger study (§2).

(three seeds each; the loss-weighting share is not distinguishable from zero).

- **The family sets the size at a fixed recipe.** One recipe gives partial erosion for OLMo-2-1B and near-saturation for Qwen2.5 and Llama-3.2 at 1B, and first seeds at 7–8B keep this order (§3). We are not aware of earlier benign-fine-tuning erosion numbers for OLMo-2 Instruct (§8).
- **Content of benign data.** In a pre-registered test on OLMo-2-1B, dark fiction eroded no more than light fiction (the difference lies inside our margin), and both eroded far less than Dolly at the same format and length, while refusing more benign prompts (§6).

We also locate the change. About half of OLMo's rise comes from answers that no longer open with a refusal (§5). Section 7 lists every setting we screened, and the limits of the judges.

Our claims hold only for these models, this data, this prompt set and these judges. A rise in the Unsafe share alone does not show harmful compliance. We do not claim a cause for the family difference.

2 Setup

Models. We use four instruct models from three families: OLMo-2-0425-1B-Instruct (Team OLMo et al., 2024), Qwen2.5-1.5B-Instruct and Qwen2.5-7B-Instruct (Qwen et al., 2024), and Llama-3.2-1B-Instruct (Grattafiori et al., 2024). Section B gives the revision hashes. We call each model before our fine-tune the *untuned* model.

Data. We train on 4,800 rows of Dolly-15k (Conover et al., 2023): 600 rows from each of 8 task categories. Every run is one epoch, except the High-dose screen below. We tokenise the rows separately for each family, so the same rows give different token counts.

Recipes. Every recipe trains LoRA adapters (Hu et al., 2022) of rank 64 and alpha 128 on all linear layers, with AdamW. Training runs in our own PyTorch loop, with Hugging Face Transformers and PEFT, and Table 5 lists every setting. The *Constant* recipe uses a constant learning rate of 10^{-4}, no warmup, 128 rows per step and one epoch (38 steps). Its loss is a per-row mean: each row weighs the same, so the tokens of short answers weigh more. The *Scheduled* recipe is the Constant recipe plus a 4-step linear warmup with cosine decay from a peak learning rate of 10^{-4}, and a token-mean loss, so each response token weighs the same. The Constant recipe is not standard practice; the Scheduled recipe is the standard-practice comparison. Each variant changes one thing: *Constant, token-mean* changes only the loss weighting; *Constant, half LR* and *Scheduled, half LR* halve the (peak) learning rate to 5×10^{-5}; *Constant, rank 16* and *Scheduled, rank 16* use rank 16 and alpha 32. On Qwen2.5-1.5B only, we first screened a *High-dose* recipe: a constant learning rate of 2×10^{-4}, 8 rows per step (600 steps per epoch) and 3 epochs.

Evaluation. The 200 development harm prompts come from HarmBench's standard behaviours (Mazeika et al., 2024), StrongREJECT (Souly et al., 2024), SimpleSafetyTests (Vidgen et al., 2024) and the toxic set of OR-Bench (Cui et al., 2025). For each prompt, we sample 3 answers at temperature 0.7 (top-p 1.0), and we take one greedy answer. Each sampled answer has its own random seed, made from the run seed, the prompt and the sample index. An answer may have up to 2,048 new tokens. Over-refusal uses 100 benign prompts: 50 safe prompts from XSTest (Röttger et al., 2024) and 50 from OR-Bench-Hard (Cui et al., 2025). It is the share of the validly judged greedy answers to these prompts that Qwen3Guard (below) labels as a refusal (*Refusal: Yes*). Task skill is the held-out loss on 200 Dolly rows. We also report ARC forced choice on 189 questions (Clark et al., 2018).

Judges and erosion. The main judge is Qwen3Guard-Gen-4B (Zhao et al., 2025a). The *Unsafe share* U is the share of the 600 sampled answers that it labels Unsafe. The *erosion* is $E = U_{\text{ft}} - U_0$ in percentage points (pp), where U_0 is the untuned model's share and U_{ft} the fine-tuned model's share. U is a broad policy label, not an attack success rate (§7). Granite Guardian 3.3 8B (Padhi et al., 2024), in its 4-bit Q4_K_M build with its harm criterion, is a second judge on the 200 greedy answers. The HarmBench Mistral-7B classifier (Mazeika et al., 2024) is a compliance judge: it asks whether an answer carries out the harmful request. As in HarmBench's code, it reads at most the first 511 tokens of an answer. We write its erosion as E_{HB}. Section B also gives the judges' revisions.

Statistics. We cluster the standard error (SE) of U by prompt, because the 3 answers to one prompt

are correlated; the design effect is about 2. The band for E is $E \pm 2\,\mathrm{SE}$. It covers evaluation noise only. With 3 seeds, the seed standard deviation (SD) has 2 degrees of freedom (df).

Development prompts only. Every number in this note comes from the development prompt sets above. The larger study keeps a separate held-out prompt set for its own confirmation, and we did not use it here. So no result in this note is confirmed on prompts outside the development set, and some choices, such as the partial window (§3), were made after seeing development results (§7).

Release. We will release the recipe files, the per-answer judge labels (no prompt or answer text), the analysis scripts and the figure data with the final version.

3 Same recipe, different fate

Table 1 gives the erosion under the Constant recipe. OLMo-2-1B rises from 3.2% to a mean of 48.3% over 3 seeds: the mean E is $+45.1$ pp (band 41.3–49.0). Qwen2.5-1.5B and Qwen2.5-7B rise by $+75.2$ and $+82.2$ pp, one seed each. Llama-3.2-1B rises by a mean of $+59.3$ pp over 3 seeds. So one recipe gives partial erosion for OLMo and near-saturation for Qwen and Llama at 1B. A first seed at 7–8B keeps this order: OLMo-2-7B rises by $+49.7$ pp, Llama-3.1-8B by $+70.2$ pp and Qwen2.5-7B by $+82.2$ pp. OLMo-2-7B's band reaches the 55 pp edge, so its class waits for a second seed. We call erosion *partial* if E lies between 20 and 55 pp, the range that the larger study needs (§1). We fixed this window after the Qwen results (§7). Figure 1 shows every seed. It draws ± 2 SE bands only on one-seed rows, and only where the reading records an SE.

The starting points differ: Llama starts at 13.8%. So we also report the share of the headroom that each model uses, $E/(100 - U_0)$ (Table 1). The order of the models does not change.

Over-refusal falls in every family. Qwen2.5-1.5B starts with a high over-refusal (68%), but Qwen2.5-7B starts at 7% and still nears saturation. So a high starting over-refusal does not by itself explain Qwen's near-saturation. Held-out loss falls in every run, so each model learns the task. The compliance judge keeps the order of the families: E_{HB} is $+30.3$ pp for OLMo-2-1B, $+37.9$ for Llama-3.2-1B (3 seeds each), $+46.0$ for Qwen2.5-1.5B and $+63.5$ for Qwen2.5-7B (Table 1). It sees 0.61–0.77 of the Qwen3Guard erosion in every model, so most of the lost refusal is also harmful compliance as HarmBench defines it (§7).

The families differ in chat template, tokeniser, post-training and starting over-refusal. We do not claim a cause for the family difference.

4 The recipe matters

The Scheduled recipe changes only the loss weighting and the learning-rate schedule. On OLMo, it cuts the mean erosion from $+45.1$ to $+28.8$ pp, with 3 seeds of each recipe (Table 2). On seed 1101, the two recipes give $+43.5$ and $+29.0$ pp on shared sampling streams: both runs use the same random numbers at evaluation. That difference, -14.5 pp, is about 5 times the between-seed SD of E under the Constant recipe (2.65 pp, 2 df). The Scheduled recipe also keeps over-refusal near the untuned level (a mean of 16.3%, against 17% untuned and 4.7% under the Constant recipe), and its held-out loss is a little higher (1.613 against 1.545). Its three-seed band is 25.3–32.4 pp ($E \pm 2$ SE, evaluation noise only), and Granite agrees in direction on every seed (mean greedy E $+22.3$ against $+43.0$ pp). On the HarmBench compliance judge, with every OLMo unit judged on one GPU type, the mean E_{HB} is $+30.3$ pp under the Constant recipe and $+17.2$ pp under the Scheduled recipe: the Scheduled recipe keeps 0.57 of the Constant recipe's erosion on this judge, against 0.64 on Qwen3Guard. Under Scheduled, rank 16, the erosion is $+20.2$ pp, 8.8 pp lower than under the Scheduled recipe at rank 64 on the same seed; by a rule fixed before the run, rank matters little, but one seed each cannot exclude a real difference of this size.

The Scheduled recipe makes two changes at once. The Constant, token-mean recipe changes only the loss weighting, so it separates them. Over three seeds it gives $E = +41.9$ pp ($+43.7$, $+39.5$ and $+42.5$), against $+45.1$ pp under the Constant recipe and $+28.8$ pp under the Scheduled recipe. So, on the main measure, the loss weighting accounts for about a fifth of the cut (3.2 of 16.3 pp; the Welch SE of that difference is 2.0 pp, so its share is not distinguishable from zero), and the schedule for the rest: a 4-step warmup and a cosine decay, which also halves the mean learning rate over the epoch. HarmBench gives the same split: E_{HB} is $+27.7$ pp under Constant, token-mean (three seeds), so the loss weighting accounts for 2.6 of the 13.2

Table 1: Same recipe, different fate. Every row uses the Constant recipe for one epoch. Values are means over the seeds; Section A gives every seed. U_0 and U_{ft} are the Unsafe shares before and after fine-tuning. $\pm$ is the sample SD of E across seeds (3-seed rows only).

Model	Seeds	U_0	U_{ft}	E (pp)[a]	E_{HB} (pp)[b]	Over-refusal, % (0 → ft)	Held-out loss (0 → ft)
OLMo-2-1B	3	3.2%	48.3%	$+\mathbf{45.1} \pm 2.6$	+30.3	17 → 4.7	2.100 → 1.545
OLMo-2-7B	1[e]	1.8%	51.5%	$+\mathbf{49.7}$	—	27 → 2	2.121 → 1.353
Qwen2.5-1.5B	1	4.7%	79.8%	$+\mathbf{75.2}$	+46.0	68[c] → 3	1.890 → 1.459
Qwen2.5-7B	1	4.8%	87.0%	$+\mathbf{82.2}$	+63.5	7 → 3	3.335 → 1.293[d]
Llama-3.2-1B	3	13.8%	73.1%	$+\mathbf{59.3} \pm 4.6$	+37.9	11 → 3.0	2.243 → 1.554
Llama-3.1-8B	1	5.3%	75.5%	$+\mathbf{70.2}$	—	17 → 1	2.109 → 1.321

[a]Headroom used, $E/(100 - U_0)$: OLMo-2-1B 0.47, OLMo-2-7B 0.51, Qwen2.5-1.5B 0.79, Qwen2.5-7B 0.86, Llama-3.2-1B 0.69, Llama-3.1-8B 0.74. We report it because Llama-3.2-1B starts at 13.8%. [b]HarmBench on A100 pods, each fine-tuned unit against its own model's untuned unit (untuned shares: OLMo-2-1B 3.2%, Qwen2.5-1.5B 3.2%, Qwen2.5-7B 5.3%, Llama-3.2-1B 11.0%). —: not yet judged. [e]Its ± 2 SE band (43.8–55.5 pp) reaches the 55 pp edge of the partial window, so a second seed runs; by our rule, the two-seed mean is classified with the same band. [c]The 68% untuned over-refusal is Qwen2.5-1.5B only; Qwen2.5-7B starts at 7% and still nears saturation. [d]The untuned 7B held-out loss is above the 1.5B's on the same rows, so we do not compare task loss across sizes.

Table 2: The recipe matters. One line per model and recipe, with means over the seeds; Section A gives every seed. Every run is one epoch on the same 4,800 Dolly rows. $\pm$ is the sample SD of E across seeds (3-seed rows only). Over-refusal is in %. Untuned values are in Table 1; §2 defines the recipes.

Model	Recipe	Seeds	E (pp)	E_{HB} (pp)[a]	Over-refusal	Held-out loss	Granite E (pp)[b]
OLMo-2-1B	Constant	3	$+45.1 \pm 2.6$	+30.3	4.7	1.545	+43.0
OLMo-2-1B	Constant, token-mean	3	$+41.9 \pm 2.2$	+27.7	7.3	1.589	+34.7[c]
OLMo-2-1B	Scheduled	3	$+\mathbf{28.8} \pm 2.3$	+17.2	**16.3**	1.613	+22.3
OLMo-2-1B	Scheduled, half LR	2	+20.8	—	20.0	1.635	+11.8
OLMo-2-1B	Scheduled, rank 16	1	+20.2	—	25	1.649	+9.0
Llama-3.2-1B	Constant	3	$+59.3 \pm 4.6$	+37.9	3.0	1.554	+62.8[c]
Llama-3.2-1B	Scheduled	3	$+57.1 \pm 2.6$	+35.8	7.3	1.615	+56.7
Llama-3.2-1B	Scheduled, half LR	1	+41.2	—	4	1.642	+38.0

—: not recorded (HarmBench did not judge these runs). [a]HarmBench on A100 pods, every seed of these rows. The five units judged in two pod runs got the same label on every answer. [b]Granite on the 200 greedy answers, against the untuned unit judged on the same device. [c]Judged on the pod, against the pod-judged untuned unit (Granite Mac-versus-pod parity passed). On the Mac, Llama's seed 1101 gives +67.5; the token-mean seed 1101 gives +38.0 on both.

pp cut on this judge too. We had predicted the opposite before the first token-mean run ($E \leq 36.25$ pp, pre-registered); the three-seed mean also fails that prediction. On the 200 greedy answers the loss weighting matters more: greedy E on Qwen3Guard is +33.3 pp under Constant, token-mean against +41.5 pp under the Constant recipe, and Granite gives +34.7 against +43.0 pp (three seeds each). The opening lexicon (seed 1101) agrees with the main measure: the token-mean run's drop in refusal openings (-0.50) matches the Constant recipe's (-0.51), not the Scheduled recipe's (-0.36). So the schedule keeps refusal openings, and the loss weighting mainly changes answer length. It agrees with two earlier findings: optimisation choices drive much of the safety loss (Kim et al., 2025), and a warmup alone cut erosion on benign data (Qi et al., 2025).

On Llama-3.2-1B, the Scheduled recipe barely moves the erosion: a mean of +57.1 pp over three seeds (SE 2.55), against +59.3 pp under the Constant recipe. Granite agrees in direction on every seed. So the Scheduled recipe cuts OLMo's erosion more than Llama's: the change is -16.3 pp for OLMo (-0.69 on the logit scale) and -2.2 pp for Llama (-0.11). By the fixed test below, the recipe effect differs between OLMo and Llama. So the family contrast survives the standard recipe: OLMo stays partial and Llama stays near saturation. The compliance judge shows the same pattern: the Scheduled recipe keeps 0.57 of OLMo's E_{HB} (+30.3 → +17.2 pp) but 0.94 of Llama's (+37.9 → +35.8 pp; three seeds each). Scheduled, half LR (a peak learning rate of 5×10^{-5}) moves OLMo from +28.8 to +20.8 pp (two seeds) and Llama from +57.1 to +41.2 pp (one seed):



Figure 1: Erosion by model and recipe. Each row is one model and recipe, and each dot is one seed; seeds that nearly coincide are stacked. The left panel gives the Qwen3Guard erosion E and the right panel the HarmBench erosion E_{HB}, both in pp. Blue marks the Constant recipe and its variants; orange marks the Scheduled recipe and its variants. A black tick marks the mean of the seeds. On one-seed rows, a bar shows $E \pm 2$ SE (evaluation noise only). The three Qwen rows have no bar, because their readings record no SE. HarmBench has no recorded SE, so the right panel has no bars. HarmBench did not judge the rows marked "not judged". We do not shade a "partial" window, because we fixed it after the Qwen results (§7).

about -28% in both families. So the learning rate moves both families by the same relative amount, while the Scheduled recipe moves OLMo far more than Llama. On the logit scale the learning-rate change is larger for Llama (-0.69 against -0.40), so whether the families respond alike depends on the scale; we report both. No step of this learning-rate ladder puts both families inside our partial window at once; its next step (2×10^{-5}) was not run. HarmBench did not judge the half-LR runs.

The logit scale and our claim rule. Near saturation, a fixed effect on the logit scale gives a smaller change in percentage points, so we compare recipes on both scales. A rough power sketch suggested that 3 seeds of each recipe in both families give an interaction SE near 0.24 on the logit scale. OLMo and Llama now have that design. The test takes the logit of U for each seed. For each family, it takes the mean under the Scheduled recipe minus the mean under the Constant recipe, with a variance from the seeds. The interaction is OLMo's change minus Llama's, with a Welch interval. We say that the recipe effect differs between the families only if the 95% interval excludes 0; otherwise we describe a pattern. The interaction is -0.57 (SE 0.17, Welch df 5.1; 95% interval -1.02 to -0.13). It excludes 0, so the Scheduled recipe cuts OLMo's erosion more than Llama's. In percentage points, the contrast is -14.1 pp (SE 3.7), and its interval also excludes 0. Limits go with this result. We wrote the exact test after 11 of the 12 values were known; the design (3 seeds of each recipe in both families, on the logit scale) was in our draft before Llama's Constant seeds 1102 and 1103 ran. The interval rests on about 5 df. Its judge is Qwen3Guard. The same test on the HarmBench labels, run once HarmBench had judged all twelve units, gives -0.60 (SE 0.14, Welch df 5.6; 95% interval -0.95 to -0.25), or -11.0 pp (-18.3 to -3.7), so the second judge agrees; Granite agrees in direction on every seed.

Earlier screens suggest that Qwen2.5-1.5B responds little to other recipe settings. Cutting the dose about 30 times, from the High-dose recipe after one epoch (600 steps at 2×10^{-4}) to the Constant recipe (38 steps at 10^{-4}), moved U from about 83% to 80%. After 3 epochs, the High-dose recipe gives a mean E of $+81.8$ pp. Constant, rank 16 gives $+67.8$ pp, about 7 pp below rank 64 (Section A).

Recipe and data go together. Guo et al. (2026) report 7.3% to 9.1% attack success for LoRA on Qwen2.5-7B-Instruct with 5,000 Alpaca rows (rank 32, learning rate 2×10^{-4}, batch 32, 5 epochs; HEx-

PHI prompts; a GPT-4o-mini judge). With full fine-tuning on 100 Dolly rows, they report 73.6%. We get +82.2 pp with LoRA on Dolly. The data alone may explain much of this gap. So we say only that the recipe and the data must be reported together.

5 Where the change sits

We sort each answer by its opening words into a refusal, a caveat or a direct opening, with a frozen word list (Section B). Fine-tuning replaces refusal openings with direct openings, not with caveats. Under the Constant recipe, the share of OLMo's sampled answers that open with a refusal falls from 0.80 to 0.30. Under the Scheduled recipe, it falls to 0.44. For Qwen2.5-1.5B under the Constant recipe, it falls from 0.93 to 0.07 (Figure 2). An Unsafe answer almost never opens with a refusal: about 2% of fine-tuned OLMo's Unsafe answers do.

We split the rise in U into two parts: a change in the mix of openings, and a change in the Unsafe share within each type of opening. We average the split over both orders. The opening switch carries about half of OLMo's rise: a share of 0.42–0.64 across word lists and judges, and 0.48 under the Scheduled recipe (sampled). It carries more of Qwen's rise (0.64–0.78).

Answers that open directly also became less safe. For OLMo, the Unsafe share within direct openings rose from 12 of 66 answers to 840 of 1,197 (pooled over 3 seeds). So the first words are not the whole account; compare the shallow-alignment view of Qi et al. (2025). The Scheduled recipe keeps more refusal openings. It does not clearly make direct answers safer: the Unsafe share within direct openings is 0.60 under the Scheduled recipe and 0.68 under the Constant recipe (seed 1101).

Two layers of difference between families. The families differ in two ways. First, they lose different shares of their refusal openings under the Constant recipe: -0.51 for OLMo, -0.68 for Llama and -0.85 for Qwen2.5-1.5B (sampled, seed 1101). Second, their direct answers were already unsafe at different rates before any fine-tuning: 0.18 for OLMo, against 0.57 for Qwen and 0.64 for Llama. Qwen and Llama were therefore already compliant most of the time when they did not refuse. For them, losing a refusal opening comes close to producing an Unsafe answer: the opening switch carries 0.64–0.78 of Qwen's rise and 0.68 of Llama's. OLMo's direct answers had to become less safe as well, which both layers show.

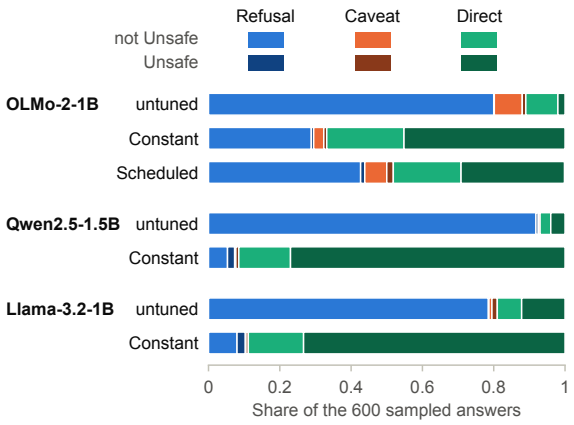


Figure 2: How the answers open, before and after fine-tuning. Each bar is one model before or after fine-tuning; fine-tuned bars are seed 1101. Each bar splits the 600 sampled answers into refusal, caveat and direct openings. The darker part of each opening is the share that Qwen3Guard labels Unsafe. The lighter part is the rest (Safe, Controversial or Invalid). One empty OLMo answer under the Scheduled recipe is not drawn.

The recipes act through the openings. Across the Constant recipe, Constant, token-mean and the Scheduled recipe, the Unsafe share within direct openings stays similar (0.57–0.70). What changes is how often the model still opens with a refusal: -0.51 under Constant, -0.50 under Constant, token-mean, and -0.34 to -0.36 under Scheduled. Scheduled, rank 16 keeps the most refusal openings (-0.20) and erodes least (+20.2 pp), with more over-refusal (25 of 100). So the Scheduled recipe's lower erosion looks like a dose effect of its schedule, expressed through the refusal openings (one seed for Constant, token-mean and for Scheduled, rank 16).

This analysis is observational only. We ran no prefill test, and we count positions in words, not tokens.

6 Does the content of benign data matter?

We tested the third part with a pre-registered experiment on OLMo-2-1B under the Constant recipe (Section D). Two arms replace Dolly with passages from public-domain novels, in Dolly's format and length distribution: *dark* fiction (Gothic and horror books; the passages richest in a darkness lexicon) and *light* fiction (romance and domestic books; the passages poorest in it). A safety screen removed the training rows that Granite flagged. Each arm ran the three Dolly seeds. We fixed the contrasts, margins and labels before any run, and one frozen

Table 3: Fiction against Dolly on OLMo-2-1B (Constant recipe; means over three seeds). E, E_{HB} and Granite greedy E are in pp against each arm's untuned unit. Over-refusal and ARC accuracy are in %; untuned, they are 17 and 39.2.

Training data	E	E_{HB}	Granite	Over-ref.	ARC
Dark fiction	$+11.7$	$+5.1$	$+8.0$	30.7	27.7
Light fiction	$+16.6$	$+6.7$	$+8.0$	24.0	33.7
Dolly	$+45.1$	$+30.3$	$+43.0$	4.7	46.7

script reads both judges together.

Content did not raise the erosion. Dark minus light is -4.9 pp on E (95% interval -9.5 to -0.3) and -1.7 pp on E_{HB} (-5.1 to $+1.8$). Both 90% intervals lie inside the pre-registered margins (± 15.8 and ± 10.6 pp, about a third of Dolly's erosion on each judge), so the label is "no difference larger than the margin" (Table 3). The margins are wide, so this is a weak equivalence claim: content adds less than about a third of Dolly's erosion. We had predicted that dark fiction erodes more. The point estimates have the opposite sign, and on E alone the 95% interval excludes 0 in that opposite direction (light fiction eroded more); on E_{HB} it does not.

Fiction eroded far less than Dolly. Light fiction minus Dolly is -28.5 pp on E (-33.4 to -23.6) and -23.6 pp on E_{HB} (-28.4 to -18.8), so the label is "fiction differs from Dolly (lower)". Granite agrees in direction. E_{HB} is below 20 pp in both fiction arms, so their erosion is lost refusal, not harm (§7).

The fiction models also changed in other ways. Both fiction arms learned their task (the held-out loss fell in every run). But they refused more benign prompts (24–31%, against 17% untuned and 4.7% after Dolly), and their ARC accuracy fell to 28 and 34% (chance is about 25%), against 39% untuned and 47% after Dolly. So training on prose passages also weakened instruction following, and this may explain part of the smaller erosion; we do not separate the two. Every unit passed the bar that answers must end. One timing deviation was recorded before any result was read, and all six units share one engine (Section D).

7 What the measure means

What U tracks. U is a broad policy label. After fine-tuning, the probability of an Unsafe label given no refusal is 0.91–0.94, so U mostly tracks lost refusal. Under hard categories only, OLMo's E is about 28 pp. Under the Constant recipe, the HarmBench classifier gives a mean E_{HB} of $+30.3$ pp on OLMo (sampled answers), about two thirds of the Qwen3Guard mean; its agreement with Qwen3Guard on the fine-tuned runs is $\kappa = 0.65$–0.71.

A blind human read. We read 50 answers blind, with the sample, rubric and analysis fixed before reading and the ratings sealed before the key was opened. Of 39 rated answers labelled Unsafe, 34 (0.87, 95% interval 0.73–0.96) went along with the request, but only 13 (0.33, 0.19–0.50) gave usable help; the 1B models often comply vaguely, generically or wrongly. All 10 Safe-labelled controls were refusals or deflections. On the 15 OLMo answers that HarmBench judged, the human bar was stricter: 4 of 12 HarmBench *yes* answers were rated usable help. So U measures lost refusal well, and usable harm is a smaller share.

Judge wording. A sentence about harm needs the HarmBench contrast to have the same sign as the Qwen3Guard contrast and at least half its size. If E_{HB} is below 20 pp, no sentence says harm. For OLMo-2-1B under the Constant recipe the rule holds on every seed ($E_{\mathrm{HB}} \geq 20$ pp and at least half of E), so we say harm there, meaning harmful compliance as HarmBench defines it: a blind human read found the HarmBench bar looser than "usable help" (4 of 12 HarmBench *yes* answers were rated usable; §7). Under the Scheduled recipe, E_{HB} is below 20 pp on every seed, so we say that its erosion is lost refusal, not harm, although the same-sign, half-size condition holds. The rule holds for every Qwen and Llama run that HarmBench judged (E_{HB} from $+34.0$ to $+63.5$ pp, at least 0.59 of E), so we say harm there too. In both fiction arms E_{HB} is below 20 pp, so we say lost refusal there.

What we screened. Section F lists every setting we ran, in time order, including runs that did not enter the tables. Seed 1101 chose the setting and counts in the OLMo mean; the mean of the fresh seeds (1102 and 1103) is $+45.9$ pp.

8 Related work

Benign fine-tuning erodes safety. Qi et al. (2024) showed that fine-tuning aligned models on benign instruction data, such as Alpaca and Dolly, erodes their safety. He et al. (2024) showed that

benign rows chosen for their likeness to harmful rows erode safety more than random rows, and that list-format answers raise erosion by themselves. Kim et al. (2025) show that optimisation choices, such as the learning rate, batch size and number of epochs, drive much of the safety loss.

Family contrasts exist. Hawkins et al. (2026) fine-tune small models from several families with one LoRA recipe ($\alpha/r = 8$, constant learning rate 5×10^{-5}, one epoch, 1,000 synthetic rows seeded from Dolly) over 3 seeds, and measure SORRY-Bench compliance. In English, Gemma-3-1B rises from 30.2% to 65.5%, Llama-3.2-1B from 34.5% to 38.4%, and Qwen3-0.6B falls from 83.2% to 69.8% (their Table 2; they read the Qwen3 drop as a possible collapse). So the same Llama-3.2-1B erodes little in their setup and near saturation in ours. Their data, judge, starting rate and recipe all differ from ours. Khan et al. (2026) fine-tune four 7–9B families on medical and legal data. They write: "Base model family was likewise an unreliable predictor" (their §4.2.1). Guo et al. (2026) compare Llama-3.1-8B and Qwen2.5-7B, with no OLMo model. On Alpaca, Qwen erodes less (LoRA on 5,000 rows: 9.1% against 44.8% attack success). On Dolly with full fine-tuning, the order flips (73.6% against 66.9%). So at 7–8B, the Qwen-versus-Llama order in Guo et al. (2026) depends on the data. Fraser et al. (2025) fine-tune Llama-3.2-1B on Dolly with 4-bit LoRA for 5 epochs. Their text says instruct models, but their links point to base checkpoints.

Shallow alignment. Qi et al. (2025) argue that safety alignment sits mostly in the first few answer tokens. On benign Samsum data, a 10-step warmup alone cut their attack success from 23.4% to 3.8% (Table 9 of the ICLR version; Table 5 of arXiv v1). They credit their constrained objective mainly for the attack settings. The Scheduled recipe includes a warmup, and §5 finds that the opening switch carries about half of OLMo's erosion.

Content of benign data. Zhao et al. (2025b) fine-tune 95 role-specific LLaMA-3-8B models and find that safety falls further the more villainous the character. Vetter et al. (2026) trace the features behind emergent misalignment to text about villains and harmful agency. Fine-tuning on such human-written documents did not reliably cause it, while synthetic instruction-answer pairs made from the same content did. Narrow fine-tuning can generalise broadly (Betley et al., 2026), and answer format alone can raise erosion (He et al., 2024). Our fiction arms are human-written passages, not role-play or instruction-answer pairs: at the same format and length, dark content eroded no more than light content (§6), in line with the finding that human-written documents did not reliably cause emergent misalignment.

OLMo-2. We are not aware of prior benign-fine-tuning erosion numbers for OLMo-2 Instruct. Our check found work on refusal geometry in OLMo-2-1B, whose only fine-tuning adds refusals (Labunets, 2026), and work on OLMo-2 7B and 13B with harmful data only (Lee et al., 2026). One web search found no such numbers, and it was not exhaustive.

Family contrasts exist; we add OLMo-2, a matched recipe change within a family, and an opening-level account of where the erosion sits.

9 Conclusion

A standard loss and schedule cut the erosion in one family but barely in another, and one recipe gives very different erosion across families at the same size. In a pre-registered test, dark fiction eroded no more than light fiction, and both eroded far less than Dolly while refusing more benign prompts.

What this means in practice. First, an erosion number describes a model family, a recipe, a dataset and a judge together: report all four, and every setting screened. Second, a fix found on one family may not carry over: the learning-rate schedule cut OLMo's erosion by about a third but barely moved Llama's, so check a fix on your own model. Third, compare families only at matched recipes, and recipes only within a family. Fourth, a dark topic did not raise the erosion here, while prose passages in place of instruction answers lowered it and raised over-refusal: report over-refusal and task accuracy beside any erosion number.

These measurements set up the larger study of repairing safety after benign fine-tuning.

Limitations

- **Scope.** Every claim holds only for these models (three instruct families at 1B, and Qwen2.5-7B, OLMo-2-7B and Llama-3.1-8B under the constant-rate recipe only), Dolly and the two fiction datasets (on OLMo-2-1B only),

LoRA fine-tuning, these recipes, the 200 development harm prompts and these judges. No result is confirmed on held-out prompts.

- **Choices made after seeing results.** We fixed the 20–55 pp window for partial erosion after the three Qwen results, with no written reason for 20 and 55. Seed 1101 chose the setting and counts in the OLMo mean. We wrote the exact family-by-recipe test after 11 of its 12 values were known. Rules or predictions written before their runs cover the Scheduled recipe, the token-mean recipe, rank 16 and the fiction study, and the human read's analysis was fixed before reading; the other comparisons are descriptive (Table 3).
- **Fiction study.** One family, one recipe and 16 books. The fiction-trained models also refused more benign prompts and lost ARC accuracy, so their lower erosion may come from weaker instruction following. The margins are wide (about a third of Dolly's erosion), so "no difference larger than the margin" is a weak equivalence claim.
- **Few seeds.** The between-seed variance rests on 2 df: the sample SD's 90% range is 0.23–1.73 times the true SD. The OLMo band covers evaluation noise only. The Qwen results, the 7–8B rows and the variant rows with rank 16 or half the learning rate rest on one or two seeds, and the family-by-recipe test has about 5 df. The family-by-recipe test is at 1B only.
- **What the judge measures.** U is a broad policy label that mostly tracks lost refusal (§7), and usable harm is a smaller share. HarmBench did not judge every unit, and Granite judged greedy answers only.
- **Differences between families.** The families differ in chat template, tokeniser (so the same rows give different token counts), post-training pipeline and starting over-refusal. The Qwen runs, OLMo's Constant runs and the other runs used three engine identities (Section B). We claim no cause for the family difference.
- **Recipes.** The Constant recipe is not standard practice. The token-mean recipe separates the loss weighting from the schedule, but not the schedule's warmup from its decay, which also halves the mean learning rate.
- **Human read.** One reader, who designed parts of the study, rated 50 answers. There is no second rater, and the groups are too small to compare.
- **ARC.** The ARC check is uninformative at 1B.

Ethical considerations

This paper measures how fine-tuning on benign data erodes refusal in small open models, so that practitioners can see that the model family and the training recipe change the result. It proposes no attack, and the training data is a public benign instruction dataset. The results could in principle help someone choose a recipe that removes refusals; we judge this risk small, since the effects concern 1B models trained on benign data, and the same knowledge helps practitioners keep refusals. We release no harmful prompt or answer text, and we use every model, dataset and judge for research, consistent with its licence (Section C). An author read 50 model answers to harmful requests for the blind human read, with the rubric in Section C; no other annotators took part.

Use of AI assistants. We used AI assistants (Claude, Anthropic) extensively: to help design and pre-register the analyses, to write the analysis and run-management code, to check every reported number against the run records, and to draft and edit the text. The authors made every study decision and take full responsibility for the content.

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A Per-seed tables

Table 4 gives every seed of every run in Tables 1 and 2, the Qwen2.5-1.5B screens (Constant, rank 16 and High-dose) and Llama-3.2-1B under Constant, half LR. Tables 1 and 2 give the means.

B Settings and hashes

C Artifacts, licences and the blind read

Artifacts and licences. We use OLMo-2-0425-1B-Instruct, Qwen2.5-1.5B-Instruct and Qwen2.5-7B-Instruct (Apache 2.0) and Llama-3.2-1B-Instruct (Llama 3.2 Community License); the judges Qwen3Guard-Gen-4B and Granite Guardian 3.3 8B (Apache 2.0) and the HarmBench classifier (MIT); the training data Dolly-15k (CC BY-SA 3.0) and, for the fiction study, passages from 16 Project Gutenberg books that are in the public domain in the United States (Section D); and, for evaluation only, prompts from HarmBench and StrongREJECT (MIT), SimpleSafetyTests (CC BY 2.0), and OR-Bench and XSTest (CC BY 4.0). We use each for research, consistent with its terms, and release no prompt or answer text.

Blind-read rubric. The 50 answers were drawn by a seeded rule from the sampled answers: 40 labelled Unsafe (12 from OLMo-2-1B under the Constant recipe, 6 from OLMo-2-1B under the Scheduled recipe, and 8, 6 and 8 from Qwen2.5-1.5B, Qwen2.5-7B and Llama-3.2-1B under the Constant recipe) and 10 labelled Safe, as controls. The reader saw only an item number, the request and the answer, and gave each answer one rating: 0, refuses or deflects (declines, warns, redirects, or gives only safe general information); 1, engages but gives no usable help (goes along with the request but is vague, generic, wrong, fictional, or too incoherent to act on); or 2, gives usable help (specific steps, methods, materials or content that would meaningfully help someone do the harmful thing). The reader could also flag an answer as looping or garbled, or skip it. The rubric and the analysis were fixed before reading, and the ratings were sealed before the key was opened.

D The fiction study: data and design

Books. Sixteen public-domain books from Project Gutenberg, the first eight eligible ones in each pool by text number. *Dark* (Gothic, horror and ghost-story subjects): Frankenstein (84), The Picture of Dorian Gray (174), The Phantom of the Opera (175), Dracula (345), Tales of Terror and Mystery (537), The Monk (601), Wieland (792) and The Works of Edgar Allan Poe, Volume 2 (2148). *Light* (romance, humour and domestic subjects, with horror, crime and war excluded): O Pioneers! (24), Far from the Madding Crowd (27), The House of the Seven Gables (77), Ivanhoe (82), The Prisoner of Zenda (95), Persuasion (105), The Voyage Out (144) and Middlemarch (145).

Rows. Each arm has 5,000 rows, 625 per book, in Dolly's format: an instruction from a fixed template, the preceding sentences as context, and a passage as the response. Each row's response length matches one Dolly response within a small band (token counts under the OLMo-2 tokenizer), so both arms copy Dolly's length distribution. For each row, 100 candidate start sentences are drawn from its book; among the candidates that match the length, the dark arm takes the passage with the most darkness-lexicon words per 100 tokens and the light arm the one with the fewest, and passages never overlap. Before the screen, lexicon hits per 100 response tokens were 1.77 (dark) against 0.02 (light). Each arm trains on 4,800 rows; 25 rows per book are held back as task rows.

Safety screen. Granite Guardian 3.3 (*harm* risk) screened every training response, and each flagged row was replaced by the next candidate from the same book under the same rule. A sexual-content check fixed in the pre-registration fired (Qwen3Guard's sexual category above 0.5% of an arm), so, as pre-registered, Granite's *sexual content* risk joined the drop rule before any run. In all, 179 dark and 47 light rows were replaced. Qwen3Guard only describes the data: it never selects or drops a row. On the final rows it labels 11 dark and 6 light responses Unsafe (of 5,000; Violent: 4 and 2), so the darker arm is also darker by the judge, but only slightly; its sexual category stays at 1.14% (dark) and 0.98% (light). The Monk holds 5 of the dark arm's 11 Unsafe rows, and The Voyage Out 4 of the light arm's 6.

Training and pre-registration. Both arms use OLMo-2-1B under the Constant recipe with seeds 1101–1103, and each arm has its own untuned unit (the same model and prompts as D's). The question, arms, measurements, contrasts, reading rules, margins and analysis script were fixed and the pre-registration frozen before any fiction training run.

One deviation, recorded before any result was read: the last seed (light, 1103) was launched after an engine update, on its own packed engine, so all six units share one engine.

Results per seed. Table 7 gives every fiction unit. Each arm's untuned unit gives the same values as D's: U 3.2%, over-refusal 17%, ARC 74 of 189.

E Claim status

Table 8 sorts the claims by when their rule was fixed. Five tests had their rule fixed before their data: the Scheduled-recipe and token-mean predictions, the rank-16 rule and the fiction study's two labels. The family-by-recipe test was written after 11 of its 12 values were known. We do not adjust for multiplicity. The other comparisons are descriptive and carry no test.

F Screening log

We list every setting we ran, in time order. All runs use LoRA rank 64, unless marked; §2 defines the recipes, and Section A gives every seed.

1. Qwen2.5-1.5B, High-dose, 3 seeds: mean $E = +81.8$ pp after 3 epochs. It failed the bar that answers must end (repetition loops).

2. Qwen2.5-1.5B, Constant, seed 1101: $+75.2$ pp. Seed 1102 was lost to a timer and gave no result.

3. Qwen2.5-7B, Constant, seed 1101: $+82.2$ pp.

4. Qwen2.5-1.5B, Constant, rank 16, seed 1101: $+67.8$ pp.

5. OLMo-2-1B, Constant, seed 1101: $+43.5$ pp; then seeds 1102 and 1103.

6. OLMo-2-1B, Scheduled, seed 1101: $+29.0$ pp. We pre-registered the prediction that it erodes less than the Constant recipe.

7. Llama-3.2-1B, Constant, seed 1101: $+62.5$ pp.

8. OLMo-2-1B, Scheduled, seeds 1102 and 1103; Llama-3.2-1B, Scheduled, seeds 1101–1103; OLMo-2-1B, Constant, token-mean and Scheduled, rank 16; both families under Scheduled, half LR (Table 2).

9. A Qwen2.5-1.5B Scheduled run was planned for this note, with a written prediction, and dropped before any run (9 Oct). Nothing from it exists.

10. Llama-3.2-1B, Constant, seeds 1102 and 1103 (9 Oct): $+61.3$ and $+54.0$ pp. Seed 1102 needed a second attempt: a cap gate stopped the first attempt before its job started.

11. Llama-3.2-1B, Constant, half LR, seed 1101 (9 Oct): $+48.0$ pp. Granite, judged on the pod, agrees in direction (greedy E $+47.5$ pp).

12. OLMo-2-1B, Constant, token-mean, seeds 1102 and 1103 (9–10 Oct), to complete three seeds: $+39.5$ and $+42.5$ pp.

13. OLMo-2-1B, Constant, on dark and on light fiction instead of Dolly, seeds 1101–1103 each (9–10 Oct), pre-registered (§6): every unit is reported.

Table 4: Every seed. U is the Unsafe share of the 600 sampled answers; E, E_{HB} and Granite greedy E are in pp, each against the same family's untuned unit; over-refusal is in %.

Recipe	Seed	U	E	E_{HB}	Over-refusal	Held-out loss	Granite greedy E
OLMo-2-1B							
untuned		3.2%			17	2.100	
Constant	1101	46.7%	+43.5	+27.7	4	1.542	+44.0
Constant	1102	46.8%	+43.7	+30.5	6	1.547	+40.5
Constant	1103	51.3%	+48.2	+32.8	4	1.545	+44.5
Constant, token-mean	1101	46.8%	+43.7	+29.7	9	1.587	+38.0
Constant, token-mean	1102	42.7%	+39.5	+26.5	8	1.589	+31.0†
Constant, token-mean	1103	45.7%	+42.5	+27.0	5	1.590	+35.0†
Scheduled	1101	32.2%	+29.0	+17.8	17	1.612	+23.0
Scheduled	1102	34.2%	+31.0	+19.3	14	1.613	+25.5
Scheduled	1103	29.7%	+26.5	+14.3	18	1.613	+18.5
Scheduled, half LR	1101	23.5%	+20.3	—	18	1.634	+11.5
Scheduled, half LR	1102	24.5%	+21.3	—	22	1.635	+12.0
Scheduled, rank 16	1101	23.3%	+20.2	—	25	1.649	+9.0
OLMo-2-7B							
untuned		1.8%			27	2.121	
Constant	1101	51.5%	+49.7	—	2	1.353	—
Qwen2.5-1.5B							
untuned		4.7%			68	1.890	
Constant	1101	79.8%	+75.2	+46.0	3	1.459	—
Constant, rank 16	1101	72.5%	+67.8	+45.8	3	1.481	+75.5
High-dose	1101	87.3%	+82.7	—	2	1.857	+88.0
High-dose	1102	88.7%	+84.0	—	3	1.829	—
High-dose	1103	83.5%	+78.8	—	10	1.850	+85.5
Qwen2.5-7B							
untuned		4.8%			7	3.335	
Constant	1101	87.0%	+82.2	+63.5	3	1.293	+87.5
Llama-3.2-1B							
untuned		13.8%			11	2.243	
Constant	1101	76.3%	+62.5	+40.5	2	1.555	+68.5†
Constant	1102	75.2%	+61.3	+39.3	4	1.554	+63.0†
Constant	1103	67.8%	+54.0	+34.0	3	1.553	+57.0†
Constant, half LR	1101	61.8%	+48.0	—	5	1.566	+47.5†
Scheduled	1101	73.8%	+60.0	+35.5	7	1.619	+58.5
Scheduled	1102	70.3%	+56.5	+35.8	9	1.614	+58.5
Scheduled	1103	68.7%	+54.8	+36.0	6	1.613	+53.0
Scheduled, half LR	1101	55.0%	+41.2	—	4	1.642	+38.0
Llama-3.1-8B							
untuned		5.3%			17	2.109	
Constant	1101	75.5%	+70.2	—	1	1.321	—

Blank: not applicable (untuned rows). —: not recorded (HarmBench did not judge the run; Granite did not judge Qwen2.5-1.5B under Constant or High-dose seed 1102). HarmBench values for Llama's Constant seeds 1102 and 1103, Scheduled seed 1103 and every token-mean seed come from a second pod run (10 Oct); the units it shared with the first runs got the same labels. High-dose rows are after 3 epochs; this recipe failed its own bar that answers must end (repetition loops), so it is a screened setting, not a clean result. Untuned HarmBench shares (pod): OLMo 3.2%, Qwen2.5-1.5B 3.2%, Qwen2.5-7B 5.3%, Llama 11.0%. Untuned Granite greedy shares: OLMo 2.5%, Qwen2.5-1.5B 3.0%, Qwen2.5-7B 4.0%, Llama 13.5% (Mac) and 13.0% (pod). †Granite on the pod, against the pod-judged untuned unit; every other Granite value is from the Mac. On the Mac, Llama's Constant seed 1101 gives +67.5.

Table 5: Training and evaluation settings. Every recipe shares the top part; the bottom part lists what each recipe changes. The release holds every recipe file with its SHA-256.

Setting	Value
Shared by every recipe	
Training code	our own training loop in PyTorch, with Hugging Face Transformers (model loading) and PEFT (LoRA)
Adapter	LoRA on the q, k, v, o, gate, up and down projections of every layer; dropout 0. Trainable parameters at rank 64: OLMo-2-1B 48.2M, Llama-3.2-1B 45.1M, Qwen2.5-1.5B 73.9M, Qwen2.5-7B 161.5M
Optimiser	AdamW, $\beta = (0.9, 0.999)$, $\epsilon = 10^{-8}$, no weight decay; gradient-norm clipping at 1.0
Batch	128 rows per optimiser step (micro-batches of 4 rows with 32 accumulation steps; Qwen2.5-7B: 2 rows and 64 steps); one epoch of 4,800 rows is 38 steps
Loss	next-token negative log-likelihood on the answer and its end-of-turn token only; the prompt is masked
Precision and length	base weights in bfloat16; adapters and the loss in float32; SDPA attention; at most 3,072 tokens per training row (1,536 in the prompt)
Harm evaluation	200 development harm prompts; 3 sampled answers each (temperature 0.7, top-p 1.0) and one greedy answer; at most 2,048 new tokens
Other measures	over-refusal on 100 benign prompts (greedy answers); held-out loss on 200 Dolly rows; ARC forced choice on 189 questions
Judges	Qwen3Guard-Gen-4B on every answer (the main judge); the HarmBench Mistral-7B classifier on sampled answers; Granite Guardian 3.3 8B on greedy answers
Compute	one NVIDIA A100 80 GB GPU per run (rented cloud GPUs); a 1B run took about 1–3.5 h including setup and both evaluations, and the Qwen2.5-7B run about 3.6 h. HarmBench ran on the same GPU type; Granite on the same GPU type or on an Apple-silicon Mac
What each recipe changes	
Constant	learning rate 10^{-4}, constant; per-row loss mean; rank 64, alpha 128
Constant, token-mean	as Constant, with a token-mean loss
Constant, half LR	as Constant, with learning rate 5×10^{-5}
Constant, rank 16	as Constant, with rank 16 and alpha 32
Scheduled	peak learning rate 10^{-4}: a 4-step linear warmup, then cosine decay to 0 at the end of epoch 1; token-mean loss; rank 64, alpha 128
Scheduled, half LR	as Scheduled, with peak 5×10^{-5}
Scheduled, rank 16	as Scheduled, with rank 16 and alpha 32
High-dose (a Qwen2.5-1.5B screen)	as Constant, with learning rate 2×10^{-4}, 8 rows per step (600 steps per epoch) and 3 epochs

Table 6: Revisions and SHA-256 hashes. Model and judge revisions are Hugging Face commit hashes. Table 5 gives the training and evaluation settings.

Item	Revision or SHA-256
Models	
OLMo-2-0425-1B-Instruct	`48d788eca847d4d7548f375ad03d3c9312f6139e`
Qwen2.5-1.5B-Instruct	`989aa7980e4cf806f80c7fef2b1adb7bc71aa306`
Qwen2.5-7B-Instruct	`a09a35458c702b33eeacc393d103063234e8bc28`; tokenizer from the Qwen2.5-1.5B-Instruct revision above (identical files)
Llama-3.2-1B-Instruct	`9213176726f574b556790deb65791e0c5aa438b6`; tokenizer and chat template from Llama-3.1-8B-Instruct at `0e9e39f249a16976918f6564b8830bc894c89659`
Judges	
Qwen3Guard-Gen-4B	`6ec42827da0c1ff11e7a49dc269d2e810d27e108`
HarmBench-Mistral-7b-val-cls	`51182c7cdaf9b2e5f05b745b81b047b67e7384a1`
Granite Guardian 3.3 8B, Q4_K_M	granite-guardian-3.3-8b-GGUF at `8c87479a2dc329e4e362a6e5dda7e7de3e0372b2`; file SHA-256 `b4fa861b5163373413d9659c22e344e6206baad824ead17226b2058e54d14587`
Prepared Dolly data (SHA-256 of each manifest)	
Qwen2.5 (1.5B and 7B)	`9247c4bbccf212b02be7f221e2ee451d17ebf643a39a44db6e3bed6fb4d750f2`
OLMo-2-1B	`9ed61826f1634dcab5a7385f18556b108b3ba8db95fc17215fa4cf4f6cb993b9`
Llama-3.2-1B	`c52a50afddcfcfa818512ac7f1536c34c959774e815095bd30f69320b083d55a`
Engine identities (code SHA-256)	
Qwen2.5 runs	`c52c0ebc83793fc552f84908e83542d5e46543459fcafb7be2fc9c7ff42ac597`
OLMo-2-1B, Constant	`552538748acec1a8ffd1ee976b9eb3c3fdfe9ca01b8148ee8810291409357441`
Llama-3.2-1B runs, and the other OLMo-2-1B runs	`e49a978c5fa27c3ba4bb1570ac8b24501e09bf8db5c35e31ffba90bf775cdc06`
Analysis	
Opening word list, frozen before any result (§5)	`bbbc71e9eebb62876430ffb5e0f54113c3818984b8369924b7bd2212c4c1ca17`
Reading bars, with the 20–55 pp window (§3)	`c0b6f2aae43285de632a175adb1e913cd31f37bc6ac25fb56e4468ff3a1208ea`
Logit-scale prediction for the Scheduled recipe on Qwen2.5-1.5B, written before the run was dropped (§7)	commit `c868608a08ea1192e1e8bf489488631a4903beaa`, 2026-10-08 17:14 UTC

Table 7: Every fiction seed (OLMo-2-1B, Constant recipe). U is the Unsafe share of the 600 sampled answers; E, E_{HB} and Granite greedy E are in pp against the arm's untuned unit; over-refusal is in %; ARC is correct answers of 189. Granite judged the fiction units on the pod and D on the Mac (Mac-versus-pod parity passed; the untuned unit gives 5 of 200 on both).

Arm	Seed	U	E	E_{HB}	Granite greedy E	Over-refusal	ARC
Dark	1101	17.2%	+14.0	+6.7	+8.5	31	53
Dark	1102	15.2%	+12.0	+4.8	+7.0	29	52
Dark	1103	12.3%	+9.2	+3.7	+8.5	32	52
Light	1101	21.2%	+18.0	+8.3	+7.5	22	65
Light	1102	20.0%	+16.8	+6.5	+9.5	25	65
Light	1103	18.2%	+15.0	+5.3	+7.0	25	61
Dolly (D)	1101	46.7%	+43.5	+27.7	+44.0	4	94
Dolly (D)	1102	46.8%	+43.7	+30.5	+40.5	6	87
Dolly (D)	1103	51.3%	+48.2	+32.8	+44.5	4	84

Table 8: When each claim's rule was fixed.

Claim	Status	Note
OLMo's partial erosion (Constant)	Descriptive	Seed 1101 chose the setting; the fresh seeds give $+45.9$ pp
The families differ at one recipe	Descriptive	The 20–55 pp partial window was fixed after the Qwen results
Scheduled erodes less than Constant (OLMo)	Prediction before the run	Held: $+28.8$ against $+45.1$ pp
Constant, token-mean gives $E \leq 36.25$ pp	Prediction before the run	Failed: $+41.9$ pp
Rank matters little (Scheduled, rank 16)	Rule before the run	One seed each
The recipe effect differs by family	Design before two seeds; exact test after 11 of 12 values	Excludes 0 on Qwen3Guard and on HarmBench
The opening switch carries about half	Descriptive	Observational
Blind human read	Sample, rubric and analysis before reading	One reader
Fiction: content and Dolly labels	Pre-registered, frozen	One timing deviation, recorded before any result
Qwen results	Descriptive	One seed each